First-Year FAQ

First-Year Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Starting at Aetheria Academy can be overwhelming. We have compiled this extensive FAQ to address the most common concerns of our incoming first-year students and their guardians.

ENROLLMENT AND ARRIVAL

Q: How do I get to the Aether-Train at Central Terminus?
A: The entrance to the platform is concealed from the Unattuned. You must walk directly at the shimmering distortion between platforms 9 and 10. Do not hesitate or slow down, or the spatial rift might reject you and bounce you back onto the mundane platform. It is best to do it at a brisk walk or slight run.

Q: What if I miss the Aether-Train?
A: Missing the train is a serious issue. Do not attempt to fly a hover-board to the academy on your own, as the atmospheric shielding will incinerate unauthorized objects. Send an emergency Courier-Sprite to the academy, and a faculty member will be dispatched to retrieve you.

THE ACADEMY AND QUADRANTS

Q: How does the Resonance Crystal work?
A: During the Attunement Ceremony, you will touch the ancient Resonance Crystal. It reads your innate aetheric frequency and aligns it with one of the four founders' frequencies, determining your Quadrant.

- Ignis: Courage and audacity.
- Umbra: Ambition and resourcefulness.
- Aeris: Intellect and wit.
- Terra: Loyalty and resilience.

The process is instantaneous. It does not hurt, though you may feel a slight static tingle or hear a brief musical chord.

Q: Are the Echo-Phantoms dangerous?
A: Aetheria is home to several Echo-Phantoms-harmless imprints of past Weavers that replay their routines. They cannot touch you, and you cannot touch them. However, avoid the Poltergeist-Echo 'Glitch' at all costs. He is a manifestation of chaotic kinetic energy and delights in causing physical mischief, such as unscrewing chandeliers or throwing chalk.

SUPPLIES AND PETS

Q: What companions are allowed at Aetheria?
A: Standard biological pets (like normal dogs or cats) are highly discouraged due to the ambient radiation of raw aether in the dormitories, which can cause them to mutate or become highly anxious. Students may bring one of the following sanctioned companions:

- A Courier-Sprite (for mail and messages).
- A Feline-Construct (a mechanical cat that requires no feeding but needs oiling).
- An Amphibian-Drone (popular for alchemy students, as they can test liquid toxicity).

Q: Do I need my own hover-board?
A: No. First-years are not allowed to bring their own hover-boards to the academy. The school provides a fleet of standard, speed-limited training boards for flight lessons. Yes, they are old, and yes, they might have a slight drift to the left, but they are safe.

Q: Where do I buy my school supplies?
A: The Aetherium Bazaar, hidden in the underground sector of the capital city. You can access it via the phased doorway behind the Leaky Reactor pub. Please consult your official supply list for required texts, brass mixing vials, and your primary tuning fork (conduit).

DAILY LIFE AND SAFETY

Q: What is the food like?

A: The academy employs a highly skilled team of culinary-weavers. Meals are served in the Grand Nexus and feature a wide variety of both traditional and aether-infused dishes. Dietary restrictions are easily accommodated; simply inform the table-construct of your needs.

Q: What should I do if I accidentally cause a localized gravity inversion?

A: Do not panic. Immediately stop feeding aether into the weave. Step out of the affected zone (if you are floating, try to swim through the air to the edge). Alert a prefect or faculty member immediately. Do not attempt to cast a counter-weave yourself, as this often results in a catastrophic spatial implosion.